

MGTF 419: Special Topics in Finance: CFA Level II

Spring 2026

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Office Hours: Wednesday from 11am - 1:15pm, Bloomberg Lab (adjacent to IT), and/or by Appointment (in-person or Zoom).

Section ID: 105319

Wednesday 9:00 am - 10:50 am, Room 3E107

DESCRIPTION

This class is for candidates who passed CFA Level 1 exam and are preparing for the Level 2 exam. The Level 2 exam is widely considered the most difficult of the three CFA exams even though the pass rate is slightly higher than level 1. The test format moves to a fact pattern format that requires a deeper understanding of the material.

We will look at each of the 10 major topics areas and explore the level of understanding that is required to pass the 2nd level exam. We will do applied valuation work as tested on the actual CFA exams as well as highlight study habits of successful past candidates.

OBJECTIVES

At the close of this class you will be able to:

- Prepare effectively for the 2026 Level 2 CFA Exam.
- Utilize Bloomberg commands <EQS> , <CAST>, <DDIS> for real-time context of CFA material

MATERIALS

Required

This class assumes you are a registered CFA level 2 candidate for the 2026 exam, and as such will have access to the CFA-required readings. If you are not a registered CFA L2 Candidate you can purchase the L2 required readings separately. **Please do not sign up for this class if you have not passed L1.**

COURSE SCHEDULE

Students are expected to pre-read subjects being discussed in the class and to do practice questions on their own in between class. There are graded in-class quizzes but a majority of grade is allocated on class participation.

Session	Date	Topic(s)	Reading(s)	Deliverable(s)*
1	4/1/26	Ethics, FRA preview	CFA Req'd Reading	Instructor Slide Deck
2	4/8/26	Quantitative Methods	CFA Req'd Reading	Instructor Slide Deck
3	4/15/26	Portfolio Management	CFA Req'd Reading	Instructor Slide Deck
4	4/22/26	Econ, FRA intercorporate Investments	CFA Req'd Reading	Instructor Slide Deck
5	4/29/26	Corporate Finance, FRA Multinational investing	CFA Req'd Reading	Instructor Slide Deck
6	5/6/26	Equity Investments, FRA Employee comp	CFA Req'd Reading	Instructor Slide Deck
7	5/13/26	FRA Qual/Integration	CFA Req'd Reading	Instructor Slide Deck
8	5/20/26	Fixed Income	CFA Req'd Reading	Instructor Slide Deck
9	5/27/26	Derivatives	CFA Req'd Reading	Instructor Slide Deck
10	6/3/26	Alt. Invest/Bloomberg Lab/REVIEW	CFA Req'd Reading	Instructor Slide Deck

ASSIGNMENTS & DELIVERABLES

[Explicitly designate whether specific assignments are individual or group, can or cannot involve consultation or collaboration. This will help foster academic integrity.

I – Independent, individual work only. No collaboration or consultation allowed.

C – Collaboration with classmates is allowed. However, each student must submit a deliverable.

G – Students may work together in groups and turn in one deliverable for the entire group.]

Reading Assignments - weekly reading assignments

Quizzes – for survey, practice, effort and attendance.

Exams - none

Class Participation and monitored attendance – required. All candidates must participate in the ungraded Rady Advanced Equity Valuation Tournament (Jelly Bean Contest).

GRADING

Exams and Deliverables	Points [or percentage]
Class Participation	50
Quizzes	50
Total	100

COURSE POLICIES

The over-riding goal for this class is for candidates to pass the CFA exams. As such, minimal time will be spent grading and assessing interim performance. The CFA exams are graded on a pass/fail basis, as is this class.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As members of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and in so doing protect the validity of University intellectual work. For students, this means that all academic work will be done by the individual to whom it is assigned, without unauthorized aid of any kind.

The complete UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed at:

<http://senate.ucsd.edu/manual/appendices/appendix2.pdf>

How the Honor Code applies to this course:

Honor code applies. In addition, all registered CFA Candidates are covered by the CFA Institute's Code & Standards

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation in order to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member.

The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. **No accommodations can be implemented retroactively.**

Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at (858) 534-4382 or fosorio@ucsd.edu.